Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	29 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	FreelanceHub — MERN Stack Freelancing Platform
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas

Persona: Sarah — a recent graphic design graduate starting her freelance career, who looks for project work online and represents the primary end user (Freelancer) of FreelanceHub.

What does she THINK AND FEEL?

- Wants to land real projects that match her skills and start building a reputation and steady income.
- Worries that her application will get lost among many others and that she will never know whether the client even saw it.
- Hopes to present her proposal, rate and portfolio in one simple place, without spending hours on each application.

What does she HEAR?

- Fellow graduates saying it is hard to get a first client and that applications on some sites go unanswered for weeks.
- Peers recommending platforms where the process is clear and where she can talk to the client directly.
- Clients mentioning that they prefer freelancers who show a clear proposal and a ready portfolio.

What does she SEE?

- A list of open projects with title, description, budget, duration and required skills that she can filter by her own skills.
- An Apply form where she can enter her proposal, rate and portfolio link.
- Her submitted applications with a clear status: Pending, Approved or Rejected.

What does she SAY AND DO?

- Registers as a Freelancer, logs in and browses open projects, filtering for work that suits her skills.
- Applies with a short proposal, her rate and a link to her portfolio, then checks the My Applications page.
- Once approved, chats with the client in real time about colours, fonts and design direction, and shares her drafts.

Pain (Fears, Frustrations, Obstacles)	Gain (Wants, Needs, Measures of Success)
• Frustrated by platforms where she applies and never hears back, with no way to see what happened to her application. • Anxious about sharing her rate and portfolio on a site that does not feel secure or professional. • Dislikes having to move to email or other apps just to talk to a client after being selected.	• Wants to find open projects that fit her skills quickly and apply in a few steps. • Wants to track every application's status without having to chase clients for an answer. • Success looks like an approved application, a real-time chat with the client, a finished project and a growing reputation.